and resisting India's role in Asia to arguing on Capitol Hill that to bolster US interests in Asia it was crucial to strengthen India.

As this indicates, this book also seeks to take the US-India relationship out of the South Asia box and consider the broader Asian setting in which it played out. Today, there is much discussion of the new link between the Asian subregions, of India as a democratic anchor in the Indo-Pacific, and of Delhi's Act East strategy. However, even in the first few decades of the Cold War, American and Indian policymakers saw the broader region as connected.

Indian officials worried about instability in broader Asia affecting India's interests. They did not believe it would stay contained in East and Southeast Asia, and they thought it would constrain the time and space India needed for nation-building at home. Thus, seeking stability, Delhi was active on a number of Asian issues, including the Korean and Vietnam Wars. At times, it played a leading role, such as when it helped convene the Bandung Conference of Asian and African countries. At other times, it played an intermediary role—for example, during and after the Korean War—and on the International Control Commission that supervised the implementation of the Geneva Accords in Southeast Asia. At yet other times, it resisted joining groupings in the region. And throughout, its objectives in Asia shaped its approach toward China and the US.

US policymakers, in turn, thought about India in the Asian context. Their domino theory envisioned India as part of the chain of Asian dominoes that could fall to communism and shift the balance of power in the Soviet Union's favor. It is why they worried about Indian failure. But they also saw a successful democratic India, even if it was nonaligned, as showing other Asian countries that the communist Chinese model was not the only alternative.

American and Indian policymakers did not always see regional developments in the same light. Delhi's postcolonial and Washington's anticommunist prisms at other times led to different interpretations and disagreements. This meant that each sometimes sought a larger role for the other in Asia—as a stabilizer, balancer, or influencer—but sometimes resisted it as being unhelpful.